

Benefits Eligibility and Enrollment Guide

Policy ID	HR-BEN-101	Owner	Total Rewards
Effective	January 1, 2026	Next review	January 1, 2027
Status	Current	Classification	Internal
Audience	Employees and eligible dependents	Company	Northstar Technologies (fictional)

Document notice: This policy is fictional and was created for retrieval-augmented generation testing. It is not legal, tax, medical, or employment advice.

1. Purpose and Scope

This guide explains health-plan eligibility, initial enrollment, dependent documentation, qualifying life events, coverage timing, and annual enrollment. Plan documents and local law control if they conflict with this summary.

This policy applies across company offices and approved remote locations unless a local addendum or controlling law provides a different rule. Employees should use the current policy version and ask the listed owner when facts do not fit the standard case.

2. Summary of Key Rules

Worker group	Health-plan eligibility	Initial deadline	Company contribution
Full-time, 30+ hours	Eligible	30 days from start	Standard contribution
Part-time, 20-29 hours	Limited plans where offered	30 days from start	Reduced contribution
Temporary or contractor	Not normally eligible	Not applicable	None

3. Initial Enrollment and Coverage

Newly eligible employees must submit elections within 30 calendar days of the start date. Coverage normally begins on the first day of the month following the start date when enrollment is timely, unless a plan document states otherwise. Missing the deadline generally requires waiting for annual enrollment or a qualifying life event.

4. Dependents and Verification

Eligible dependents may include a spouse, domestic partner where offered, and qualifying children. Required documentation must be submitted through the benefits portal within the stated verification window. Coverage may be delayed or canceled when documentation is incomplete. Social Security numbers and similar identifiers must not be sent through ordinary email.

5. Qualifying Life Events

Marriage, divorce, birth, adoption, loss of other coverage, and certain employment changes may permit a midyear election. Employees normally have 30 calendar days from the event to submit the change; birth and adoption may have different plan-specific rules. The election must be consistent with the event and may require supporting documentation.

6. Annual Enrollment and Plan Changes

Annual enrollment is the regular opportunity to change elections for the next plan year. Total Rewards publishes dates, rates, and plan materials before the window opens. Plans, vendors, employee contributions, and coverage terms may change. Employees should review current materials even when they intend to keep the same coverage.

7. Exceptions, Records, and Questions

Exceptions must be lawful, documented, limited in duration, and approved by the policy owner plus any other owner named in the relevant section. Approval for one case does not change the policy for other employees. Records are retained according to the company retention schedule and any legal hold.

Related documents: Retirement and Savings Plan Guide; Family, Medical, and Parental Leave Policy; Employee Onboarding 90-Day Guide.

Version history

Version	Effective date	Change
1.0	January 1, 2026	Initial fictional policy issued for RAG evaluation.